

Probiotics

How to pick one that actually works and the right dose.

Daily Dose by Weight

Probiotics are dosed by CFUs (colony forming units, the count of live bacteria). For dogs with recurring skin or gut issues, aim higher than the basic maintenance amount. Give once a day, mixed into food.

Your Dog's Weight	Daily CFU Target	Frequency
Up to 20 lbs	1 to 5 billion CFU	Once a day
20 to 50 lbs	5 to 20 billion CFU	Once a day
50 to 90 lbs	20 to 40 billion CFU	Once a day
90 lbs and up	30 to 50 billion CFU	Once a day

Strains That Actually Help Skin

- Lactobacillus rhamnosus
- Lactobacillus acidophilus
- Bifidobacterium animalis (or bifidum)
- Saccharomyces boulardii (a beneficial yeast that crowds out the bad kind)
- Bacillus strains (spore-forming, survive stomach acid better)

How to Pick a Good One

- Multi-strain beats single strain for skin and immune support
- Names the exact strains on the label, not just 'probiotic blend'
- Made specifically for dogs
- Bonus: includes prebiotics (the food that feeds the good bacteria)

GIVE IT 8 TO 12 WEEKS: You may see early improvement in 2 to 4 weeks, but rebalancing the gut and skin takes 8 to 16 weeks. Stay consistent every day. Recurring infections can signal an underlying allergy or condition, so loop in your vet if they keep coming back.